



'SMASHING THE GANGS' LATEST

A year after Starmer became PM — and scrapped Rwanda — **879** migrants crossed the Channel on Monday, with the six-month total this year at a **record high**. No one knows who they are or where they're from. But all will have to be fed, housed and given free health care — **and most will NEVER leave**



Bound for Britain:
A smuggler's boat
off the French
coast on Monday

20,000 this year... and counting

LABOUR'S abject failure to protect our borders was laid bare yesterday as it emerged a record 20,000 small-boat migrants had

By **David Barrett**
and **Neil Sears**

reached Britain in the first half of this year.

Nearly 900 arrived in Dover from

France on Monday, the latest official figures revealed.

On top of a confirmed 19,982 arrivals since the start of the year, there were at least 300 more yesterday, and the Mail witnessed scores awaiting a traffickers' 'taxi boat' off the French coast.

This means the year's tally has already hit 20,000 – a milestone not reached until mid-August in previous years. Small-boat arrivals are up by 48 per cent on the same period in 2024.

The news comes almost exactly a

Turn to Page 6